

NAME

clear – clear the terminal screen and purge scrollback buffer

SYNOPSIS

clear

DESCRIPTION

A high-fidelity replacement for the standard **clear** utility.

Standard **clear** only moves the terminal cursor to the top line of the window, leaving historical command output intact within the scrollback buffer. This refined version visually clears the screen and immediately executes hardware-level ANSI escape sequences to flush the terminal emulator's scrollback memory entirely.

THE FUNCTION

This manual entry documents the following shell function and alias configuration:

```
clear() {  
    /usr/bin/clear  
    printf '\033c\033[3J'  
}  
alias cls='clear'
```

ESCAPE SEQUENCES

The tool relies on the following low-level terminal controls via **printf**:

\033c Resets the terminal device state to its default settings.

\033[3J

Purges the entire visible and invisible scrollback history from the host terminal.

ADVANTAGES

- **Cognitive Reset:** Guarantees a truly blank canvas when shifting contexts, preventing accidental scrolling into stale data.
- **Error Tolerance:** Intercepts the Windows-style **cls** command to maintain workflow velocity across heterogeneous environments.

INSTALLATION

Add the function and alias directly to your **.bashrc** or **.functions** file. Because it is loaded as a shell function, it naturally shadows the standard binary located at **/usr/bin/clear**.

AUTHOR

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